



EDUCATION ABROAD PROGRAM

Site Visit Protocol Template

Site visits are an excellent way to gather information to share with stakeholders. They should be undertaken with specific goals in mind and well documented to ensure the goal of the site visit is met. Also, they should involve noting any need for follow-up. Review The Forum's [Guidance on Program Site Visits](#) for more information and additional site visit policy examples.

Site Visit Evaluator (name and title): _____

Please indicate the purpose of the site visit (more than one may be selected):

- ☐ Initial evaluation for a newly proposed program
- ☐ Program evaluation for ongoing partnership
- ☐ Assessment of risk for an identified "elevated risk" location (Travel Advisory Levels, recent media reports, incident reported from previous visiting groups)

PROGRAM INFORMATION

Program Title: _____

Host Organization: _____

Host or Affiliated University: _____

Location (city, country): _____

Dates of Visit: _____

TYPE OF VISIT:

- ☐ Partner organized (Familiarization Trip)
- ☐ Individually organized

ACTIVITIES ARRANGED (PLEASE SELECT ALL THAT APPLY):

- ☐ Class observations
- ☐ Student meetings
- ☐ Faculty/instructor meetings
- ☐ Sample excursion(s)
- ☐ Internship/field study observation (if available)
- ☐ Housing observation
- ☐ Tour of host campus/study abroad center
- ☐ Tour of host city/community
- ☐ Other: _____

ACADEMIC PROGRAM - TEACHING AND LEARNING

Please provide as much information as possible about the academic program offered at the study abroad site.

INSTRUCTORS (select all that apply)

- ☐ Host nationals
- ☐ Visiting instructors from around the globe
- ☐ U.S.-based instructors

INSTRUCTOR TRAINING

(select all that apply)

- ☐ Terminal degrees in an academic field
- ☐ Master's or professional degrees (MBA, J.D., etc.)
- ☐ Adjunct professionals in their fields
- ☐ Other: _____

TYPICAL CLASS STRUCTURE

- ☐ Lecture
- ☐ Seminar
- ☐ Field or lab work
- ☐ Internship
- ☐ Tutorial

TYPICAL CLASS SIZE

- ☐ Small (fewer than 10 students)
- ☐ Medium (10-25 students)
- ☐ Large/Lecture style (how many students did you observe: ____)

Please indicate who provides evaluation of student performance.

Class(es) observed and brief description:

Do the classes observed align with institutional curricular mission and goals? Why or why not?

CO-CURRICULAR PROGRAM

If you observed an internship or community-based learning experience, please provide a brief description. Please include the name(s) of the host organization(s), type of industry or engagement, and an overview of the organization itself.

Does the internship or community-based learning offer a goal- and project-based learning experience? If yes, please elaborate.

How many hours per week does the internship or community-based learning occur?

Are students afforded an opportunity to conduct structured reflection on their internship or community-based learning experience? If yes, please elaborate.

How are field trips or excursions organized? Please provide an example of a field trip or excursion organized by the partner.

Do students have access to adequate facilities designed to support their learning (i.e. library, computer labs, laboratory equipment, databases, etc.)?

How does the program take advantage of the unique learning opportunities in the destination?

Student feedback on academic and co-curricular experience:

LIVING ARRANGEMENTS

What housing arrangements did you visit/observe?

- ☐ Homestay
- ☐ Residence Hall/Dormitory
- ☐ Apartments/Flats
- ☐ Field Station

If the program offers homestays, please describe how host families are identified, selected, and oriented to house visiting students.

Do students have an opportunity to live with local students or host community representatives? If yes, please elaborate.

How far was the housing from the program/university/study abroad center?

How far was the housing from the city center?

What transportation options are available to students?

What options do students have for meals?

- ☐ Homestay provided (number of meals per day: ____)
- ☐ Student cafeteria available
- ☐ Student cooks most of their meals in a common kitchen space
- ☐ Other: _____

Are there options for students with dietary requirements? Select all that apply:

- ☐ Vegetarian
- ☐ Vegan
- ☐ Halal
- ☐ Kosher
- ☐ Gluten-free
- ☐ Dairy-free
- ☐ Nut allergies
- ☐ Other: _____

What security measures are in place at the housing facilities? Please select all you observed.

- ☐ Key card access
- ☐ CCTV
- ☐ 24 hour security staff
- ☐ Staffed check-in desk
- ☐ Trained resident assistants
- ☐ Other: _____

Student feedback on living arrangements:

ADMINISTRATION

Please provide an overview of the orientation facilitated by the host organization when students arrive.

What services does the host organization provide to students?

If this is a non-English speaking location, does the host organization offer English translation services?

Are there resources available for students of color, LGBTQ+ students, and students with learning and/or physical disabilities? If yes, please elaborate.

Student feedback on services provided by the host organization:

HEALTH AND SAFETY

Did the staff explain or provide an overview of the emergency response protocol?

Does the staff conduct regular reviews and rehearsals of emergency response protocols?

How close is the nearest hospital or medical facility?

Do students have access to general healthcare providers such as a campus health center or contracted practitioner? How long does it take to get an appointment for non-emergency problems? Is there a pharmacy near the program?

Do students have access to counseling services on-site, or near the program?

Do students know who to call in an emergency?

If this location is being reviewed for risk assessment due to a change in Travel Advisory Level, recent media coverage, or other reason, please respond to the following questions:

How has the program responded to mitigate potential risks associated with this location?

What is the interpretation of the situation by local representatives?

How are students informed of changes to advisory levels or safety?

Are there areas where students should avoid traveling as a result of safety concerns?

Where is the nearest home country embassy or consulate in relation to the program?

SUMMARY

Please describe the program highlights. What stood out to you as unique? What type of student might succeed on a program like this? Who on the home campus needs to be made aware of this program?

In what ways might there be room for improvement?

Would this program be well-suited for specific student populations? (Consider academic preparation, inclusive policies, level of independence, etc.)

Would this program be ill-suited/unsuitable for any student populations?

What is your overall assessment of this education abroad opportunity based on your observations, meetings, attended classes, and discussions with faculty and students?
